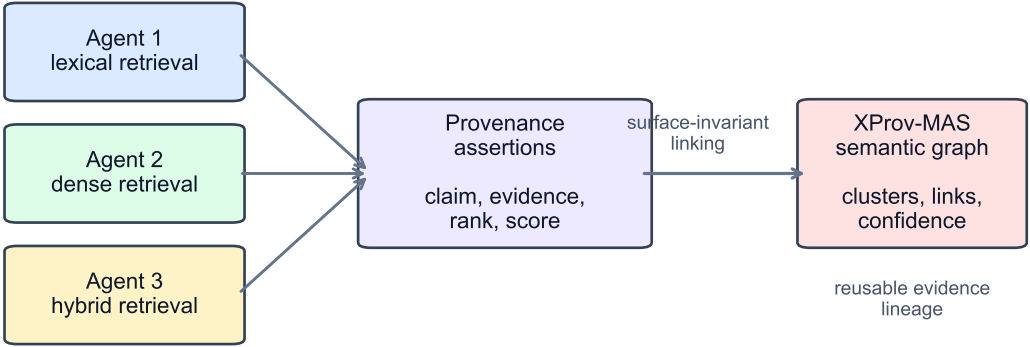Independent channels are composed after retrieval; canonical source IDs remain hidden from the linker